

hūmānus

annual report

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Humanising Justice

ACCOUNTABILITY · COMMUNITY · EVIDENCE



Our Mission

Empowering victims of serious international crimes

ACCOUNTABILITY · COMMUNITY · EVIDENCE

Our mission is to empower victims of serious international crimes and transform accountability processes. Working alongside victim groups, we support them to get justice that matters to them. Too often, victims are not included in legal processes. We strive to amplify their voices, ensuring they are heard and respected on the global stage.



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Executive Director's Statement



In 2025, hūmānus strengthened a simple commitment: accountability work is most credible and most durable when it is built with the communities who live the consequences of serious international crimes.

Our mission is to empower victims of serious international crimes and transform accountability processes. Working alongside victim groups, we support them to get justice that matters to them. Too often, victims are not included in legal processes. We strive to amplify their voices, ensuring they are heard and respected on the global stage. Our goal is for victims to have the power and agency to create their own path towards healing and justice.

We further strengthen our mission through a complete facelift: transitioning from Victim Advocates International to *hūmānus* to focus our mission on humanising justice.

2025 was also the year in which we adopted our five-year strategy for 2024–29, setting the direction for hūmānus as we enter a crucial period of growth. The strategy is organised around three goals that guide everything we do. First, that victims of serious international crimes secure outcomes in line with their own conception of justice. Second, that victims are empowered by the process of pursuing justice—not just by its results. And third, that justice processes in the wake of international crimes are transformed so as to put victims at the centre. Each of the programmes described in this report is designed to advance one or more of these objectives.

In 2025, that mission found expression across four geographies and distinct lines of work. Across our Rohingya programming, we supported community-led documentation and dialogue that connected lived experience to legal strategy, while protecting participants in an increasingly constrained operating environment.

Our dialogue work created sustained channels for communication and analysis and prepare for international advocacy moments, including the United Nations High-Level Conference on the Situation of Rohingya Muslims and Other Minorities in September 2025 in New York.

Alongside this, we continued to build practical tools that convert information into action. In India, our detention-tracking work expanded into a living database used to support bail and legal advocacy for Rohingya detainees, while also capturing the scale and patterns of detention and deportation across multiple states.

In Somalia, our work pursued answers, acknowledgment, and remedy. In 2025 we received written determinations from AFRICOM across three civilian harm cases we supported, including findings that recognised civilian harm, even as significant gaps remained in the delivery of meaningful redress.



Accountability must be built with affected communities, not about them, and it must be made tangible through evidence, advocacy, and practical pathways to remedy.

I was honoured to speak at the American Society of International Law conference in a panel debate on international accountability and also had the opportunity to address a UN event on the Youth of Myanmar on behalf of our client Maung Sawyeddollah. These platforms reflect the growing recognition of hūmānus' contribution to the field and the importance of centring the voices of those we represent.

We closed the year by bringing our team together for a retreat in Bangalore, India—a chance to connect, reflect on the year's work, and sharpen our shared direction. Across every programme and geography, the thread is the same: accountability must be built with affected communities, not about them, and it must be made tangible through evidence, advocacy, and practical pathways to remedy.

Eva Buzo

Founder & Executive Director

OUR 2024–29 STRATEGY

Three goals guide everything we do

1

Victims of serious international crimes secure outcomes in line with their own conception of justice.

2

Victims are empowered by the process of pursuing justice—not just by its results.

3

Justice processes in the wake of international crimes are transformed so as to put victims at the centre.

1

Rohingya in Bangladesh

Preserving evidence, sustaining dialogue, pursuing corporate accountability

Rohingya Atrocities Archive

The Rohingya Atrocities Archive (RAA) is a digital archive initiative designed to preserve and organise evidence of international crimes committed against Rohingya communities, and to strengthen access to structured information for accountability efforts. The RAA is the product of hūmānus' long-term partnership with the Arakan Rohingya Society for Peace and Human Rights (ARSPH), the organisation founded by Mohib Ullah, the Rohingya leader who was assassinated in 2021. The archive represents the first time that Mohib Ullah's documentation work has been made public.

Evidence deteriorates, disappears, and is contested. The RAA exists to ensure that Rohingya survivors and community-led documentation are not treated as "inputs," but as enduring records that can support legal strategy, advocacy, and historical truth-telling.

Why this matters

Accountability processes depend on credible, structured evidence. The RAA ensures that documentation produced and preserved by Rohingya communities retains its integrity, remains accessible, and can be deployed in legal and advocacy settings for years to come.

In 2025, we continued development of the digital archive, including work to create a machine-readable platform that supports advanced searching and structured use of data. Public-facing engagement included exhibitions and launch events in Ontario, Canada and London, England that helped translate evidence preservation into wider awareness and support, alongside strategic outreach to media, decision-makers and stakeholders.



Hashmat Ullah met with officials at the Foreign Commonwealth and Development Office in London to discuss his father's work.

Building the Evidence Base

In 2025, we worked with the Rohingya Justice Initiative (RJI), a Rohingya-led organisation that had undertaken comprehensive documentation efforts over a four-year period, accumulating a database of over 1,000 entries. We merged the RJI dataset with the ARSPH dataset, creating the largest database on the 2017 atrocities against the Rohingya—comprising over 4,000 entries after duplicates were removed. The partnership involved community documenters taking further statements to address gaps in the information base.

The combined dataset enabled us to undertake a major analytical exercise to identify patterns across the 2017 atrocities. This included systematic analysis of mortality figures, patterns of sexual violence, the geographic and temporal distribution of attacks, and the identification of command structures and units implicated in the violence. The analysis was subjected to peer review through Cambridge University Press.

Reparations and legal strategy

This analytical work fed directly into our partnership with Charles River Associates (CRA) to develop a reparations figure for use in the civil proceedings against Meta Inc. in Ireland. By grounding the economic assessment in the documented scale and nature of harm, the collaboration between hūmānus, community documentation partners, and CRA represents a rigorous, evidence-based approach to quantifying the losses suffered by Rohingya communities.

Our work was presented at the annual conference for the American Society for International Law in a debate on the relevance of international accountability.



RJI collecting statements from the Rohingya community in Cox's Bazaar.

Dialogue & Leadership

In partnership with the Stimson Centre, hūmānus continued our work with Rohingya leadership on dialogue and engagement. At the centre of this work are the wishes of our clients: there can be no accountability if we are not allowed to return home. Activities during the reporting period included weekly workshops that strengthened leadership confidence, with explicit focus on representation, participation, and rights-based advocacy. We facilitated inter-ethnic dialogue between Rohingya women and Rakhine women, and supported separate engagement between Bangladeshi officials and United League of Arakan personnel. Our dialogue model contributes “ground-truth” inputs that help external stakeholders, including state actors, better understand community priorities and the risks and realities of representation. This is anchored in sustained dialogue channels and real-time analysis rather than one-off consultation. The weekly rhythm of engagement means that the perspectives shared with decision-makers are current, tested in discussion, and reflective of genuine community deliberation rather than extracted talking points.

In the lead-up to the High-Level Conference on Rohingya Muslims and other Ethnic Minorities, hūmānus played a pivotal role in the setting of the terms of reference including having our proposed language on social cohesion adopted for the modalities resolution. To this end we closely engaged with Member States, including our Executive Director being asked by the Canadian Permanent Representative to the United Nations to address the United Nations Informal Working Group on Myanmar on strategies to stabilise Rakhine State. Throughout the year we worked closely with the High Representative for the Rohingya crisis and at the request of Bangladeshi officials led stakeholder consultations to feed into the strategy for the High-Level Conference.

Accountability for the Murder of Mohib Ullah

We also continued our work seeking accountability for the murder of Mohib Ullah. For this effort we work closely with Mohib’s family following a two-pronged approach. First, we have been advocating for states to designate the Arakan Rohingya Salvation Army (ARSA) as a terrorist organisation. The work made meaningful progress during the year, though the ultimate outcome has not yet been achieved.

Second, we completed a submission to the Special Rapporteur on Human Rights Defenders seeking her intervention in Bangladesh following the arrest of Atta Ullah, and requesting that Mohib Ullah’s murder be included in his charge sheet.



Our client Mohib Ullah was murdered in 2021. We will not stop fighting until his murderers are held accountable.

Meta Inc. Accountability

Our work seeking accountability against Meta Inc. advanced significantly in 2025. In Ireland, we filed statements of claim, and the civil proceedings continue to move forward on behalf of our sixteen plaintiffs. We also pursued accountability against Meta through the Securities and Exchange Commission in the United States, working alongside our partners Open Society Justice Initiative and Amnesty International. We undertook an advocacy trip to Washington, D.C. with our client Maung Sawyedollah to engage with lawmakers on the need for proper corporate accountability for the role social media platforms played in facilitating atrocity crimes against the Rohingya.

Our OECD complaint against Meta came to an end in 2025 when we withdrew after efforts to agree on mediation terms broke down. The major learning from this process was that the OECD mechanism proved too slow to be effective alongside litigation. Although we commenced the complaint in 2021, we were compelled to file civil proceedings in Ireland by August 2023 to avoid the statute of limitations lapsing. The consequence was that the OECD complaint could no longer address the issue of remedy for the Rohingya, and was limited to mediating Meta's human rights policy—which our clients determined was no longer a priority for them. The experience underscored both the limitations of non-judicial mechanisms and the importance of maintaining parallel legal strategies.



Maung Sawyedollah and Eva Buzo briefing the Committee on Banking, Housing and Urban Affairs on the SEC complaint.

2

India: Tracking Detention, Securing Freedom

Building a living record of detained Rohingya refugees to support legal intervention

94

detention cases
documented

9

Indian states
covered

120+

deportations
recorded

The India detention database project builds a living record of detained Rohingya refugees across India to support legal intervention, track trends, and enable faster response to new detentions and deportation risks. The project is a partnership between hūmānus and the Azadi Project, working together with female Rohingya field researchers who play a central role in verification and outreach.

By the end of the reporting period, the project had documented 94 detention cases across nine Indian states: Delhi, Assam, West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Telangana, Rajasthan, Jammu, and Tripura. It recorded over 120 deportations within the dataset, and the data is now actively used to support bail applications and legal advocacy for detained individuals.



India Programme Manager Arati Ranade

Three key outcomes

1. Building a cross-state network of human rights lawyers equipped to take on Rohingya detention cases.
2. A growing body of legal research including bail applications and rights-based documentation.
3. Direct legal intervention through petitions and representation before local courts.

The work responds to persistent gaps in protection. UNHCR does not track Rohingya refugees after issuing identity documents, and UNHCR cards are not recognised by Indian authorities, including courts. Rohingya refugees face routine arrests and rising hostile rhetoric that creates an atmosphere of fear, leading to frequent movement to avoid detention and deportation. In this environment, the database serves both an immediate protective function—enabling faster legal response—and a longer-term evidentiary function, building a structured record of detention patterns that can inform policy advocacy and international reporting.

3

Somalia: AFRICOM Responses on Civilian Harm

Pursuing remedy-focused accountability for civilian harm

In Somalia, hūmānus pursued remedy-focused accountability by supporting civilian harm cases and pressing for transparent determinations and meaningful redress from the United States Africa Command (AFRICOM). This work exemplifies our approach of taking up cases directly on behalf of clients and being flexible and persistent in pursuing outcomes through whatever channels are available.



In 2025, AFRICOM communicated written determinations across three cases we supported, including recognition of civilian harm in all three cases. Determination letters delivered in September 2025 formally recognised civilian harm across all three cases. Despite these determinations, condolence payments were refused, and broader questions of remedy, transparency, and follow-through continued to require sustained advocacy.

Acknowledgment without remedy is not accountability.

The written determinations represent a significant step: AFRICOM formally acknowledged that its operations caused civilian harm. However, the gap between acknowledgment and actual compensation remains a persistent challenge. hūmānus continues to press for full implementation of these determinations, including financial payments and transparency about assessment processes. These cases serve as a reference point for broader civilian harm accountability standards and demonstrate the value of sustained, victim-centred legal advocacy in securing outcomes that would otherwise not materialise.

Features | Military

'Killed us twice': Families of US drone victims seek reparations in Somalia

In letters seen by Al Jazeera, US AFRICOM admits to killing civilians in air raids, but refuses 'condolence payment'.



hūmānus' work on drone strikes was covered by a feature for Al Jazeera

4

Colombia: Forces of Inspiration

Sport, solidarity, and the power of visibility

In 2025, hūmānus' Executive Director Eva Buzo undertook a 40-kilometre open water swim from Juanchaco to Buenaventura along Colombia's Pacific coast, hosted by the Open Society Foundations as part of their "Forces of Inspiration" campaign. The swim was designed to celebrate and amplify the work of civil society groups in Buenaventura who are leading anti-violence initiatives in a city that has been heavily impacted by Colombia's decades-long conflict.

The event took place against a challenging backdrop. In the week before the swim, Colombia was struck by a series of attacks by armed actors, including in Buenaventura and nearby Cali. After consulting with local civil society partners, the decision was made to proceed—a message of peace and resilience was needed more than ever.

A message of peace and resilience was needed more than ever.



Eva Buzo receives a special commendation from the Governor of Cali



Eva Buzo meets with young athletes in Buenaventura.

What followed was extraordinary. Thousands of people gathered at Buenaventura's Malecón to welcome the swim's completion, and in the days that followed the city was in the news across Colombia not for violence, but for triumph and celebration. Hotel occupancy in Buenaventura increased by 40 percent in the days after the event. The swim served as a circuit breaker from the city's narrative of violence, and provided a platform for local civil society groups to be recognised for their tireless work building peace in their communities.

Academic Partnerships

In 2025, hūmānus benefited from partnerships with leading law schools, including Fordham Law School, Columbia Law School, and American University. Over the course of the year, we hosted eight interns who supported hūmānus with legal research across our programmes. These partnerships strengthen our capacity while providing emerging lawyers with direct exposure to victim-centred accountability work at the international level.



Interns Olga Anh, Aly Orvis and hūmānus Legal Advisor Manuela Londono in Washington DC at a team meeting.

We Are Grateful to Our Partners for 2025

hūmānus' work in 2025 was made possible by the support of the following partners:



Cowater



Swiss Embassy, Dhaka



Open Society Foundations



Foreign Commonwealth and
Development Office



Swiss Embassy, Yangon

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